

Self-Presentation

First of all, thank you very much for your time and for the opportunity to speak with you today. Before we begin, just in case you're wondering how to pronounce my name – it's *Berkant*.

Let me start with a few key facts: I'm 22 years old and currently studying Economics at the University of Nuremberg. I'm on track to complete my bachelor's degree by April 2026. At the moment, I'm doing an internship in Audit at KPMG in Munich.

Now, I'd like to share a bit about my background.

I went to school in Amberg, which is about a 60-minute commute from Nuremberg, and completed my *Abitur* (German high school diploma) in 2021.

During my school years, I was deeply involved in competitive football as I played for the youth academies of SpVgg Greuther Fürth and SSV Jahn Regensburg which are both professional clubs in Germany's 2nd division. Up until I was 18, my dream was to become a professional footballer. Unfortunately, due to serious injuries, I had to give up that path and redirect my goals.

Why do I mention this?

Balancing high school and competitive sports – especially with the four-hour daily commute to Fürth – was a real challenge. It taught me how to push my limits and perform reliably across two demanding fields." That experience taught me valuable lessons early on: how to organize my time efficiently, stay disciplined, and make sacrifices for long-term goals.

My career end pushed me to refocus and invest in my academic and personal development. I chose to study Economics because I've always been curious about how businesses grow, how markets behave, and what drives successful strategy – especially in fast-paced, competitive environments.

What began as a plan B soon turned into a genuine passion for entrepreneurship and innovation. I realized that many of the values I had developed through sport are also essential in dynamic business settings, especially in startup and scale-up companies like Emma.

After taking a short break from football, I was looking for a new challenge and decided to return to my local club – this time as a coach for both the U-10 and U-19 teams. This experience has been incredibly valuable to me personally, as it taught me how to take responsibility, communicate effectively with young players, and apply leadership in a hands-on way. Leading two teams with very different dynamics deepened my understanding of motivation, accountability, and team culture.

Through this and my broader experience in competitive sports and academics, I've developed strong organizational skills, a calm and focused mindset under pressure, and a high degree of adaptability in fast-moving environments. These are qualities I consistently draw on – and I'm confident they would allow me to make a meaningful contribution at Emma.

I like to draw parallels between high-performance sports and startup or scale-up environments. Both require adaptability, resilience, and a high tolerance for pressure. That's why I'm genuinely excited about the possibility of doing an internship at Emma. I'm looking for a dynamic and ambitious environment where I can apply the strengths I developed in sports and contribute meaningfully.

My motivation to apply specifically to Emma – The Sleep Company is very clear and came naturally to me. As a D2C brand focused on creating high-quality, innovative, and health-oriented sleep products, Emma delivers real value to people's lives. As an athlete, I deeply understand the importance of good sleep – it's fundamental not just for everyday well-being but also for peak performance, especially in sports. That's why I feel a strong connection to your mission and your product.

I'm truly looking forward to the opportunity to learn, grow, and contribute at Emma – and I'm excited about the chance to be part of a team that's shaping the future of sleep.

